

to your network, they can spread these worms through the network and infect other machines, which in turn will breach any security practices you may have in place.

The only way to combat this is to impress upon your users the importance of keeping their client PCs updated with the latest antivirus definitions and security patches. Even in your home network, you need to be careful to update all computers with the latest security fixes, or else you could end up transmitting a virus from home to computers on your office network.

War Driving

War Driving is a term used to describe a hacker that literally drives up outside a building that has a WLAN and attempts to access the network using his or her hacking tools. Some of these tools are available freely on the Net, and do not even require a hacker's level of knowledge to use. So, just about anyone armed with the right (or wrong!) tools can gain access to your network if it isn't configured properly. The solution to this is to have better access point placement, as described earlier in the same section.

Threat Outcomes

If a hacker gained access to your Wi-Fi-enabled computer, or your WLAN, there could be a multitude of outcomes, depending on what the attacker wants.

Internet Usage: More often than not, people who gain unauthorised entry to a WLAN will use your Internet connection. This gives them free Internet access, and shields them from being traced on the Net—much like what an anonymiser service does. Though this may not sound as bad, it is in fact worse than you can imagine. Most people's activities online are governed by whether or not they feel secure about their identity being hidden. A user who gains unauthorised access to your network knows that all his activities can only be traced back to you, and thus may use your network to download warez, surf illegal pornography Web sites, or send spam and worms out on to the Internet. Depending on which